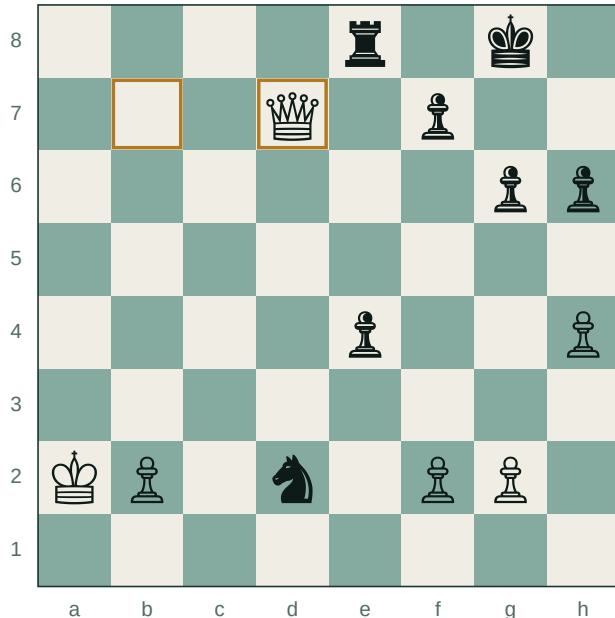


Anastasia mating nets: Black, move 39

Anastasia mating nets

Black to move



Previous move: 39.Qd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

39...Ra8+ 40. Qa4 Rxa4#

39...Ra8+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **40.Qa4**.

40...Rxa4# Mate: rook on a4 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on a4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An Anastasia-type net uses a knight to restrict king escapes while a rook or queen checks along an edge file. Removing a pawn shield can be the crucial preparation.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on a2. Geometrically undefended: queen on d7. Check for tactical protection.